

# Schur Rings Over Numerical Semigroups

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June 18, 2026

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# Numerical Semigroups

## Definition

A Numerical Semigroup is a subset of the natural numbers which is closed under addition.

## Example

- $\mathbb{Z}^+$
- $n\mathbb{Z}^+, \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$
- $\{3, 5, 6, 8, 9, 10, 11, \rightarrow\}$

# Properties of Numerical Semigroups

Any numerical semigroup can be reduced to a finite generating set.

## Example

- $\mathbb{Z}^+ = \langle 1 \rangle$
- $n\mathbb{Z}^+ = \langle n \rangle$
- $\{3, 5, 6, 8, 9, 10, 11, \rightarrow\} = \langle 3, 5 \rangle$

It can be assumed the gcd of a generating set is 1.

# Properties of Numerical Semigroups, Cont.

A numerical semigroup with at least two generators greater than 0 has a Frobenius number and a conductor.

## Definition

The Frobenius number is the greatest integer not in the semigroup, e.g.  $F(\langle 3, 5 \rangle) = 7$

## Definition

The Conductor is the smallest element of the numerical semigroup such that all greater natural numbers are in the semigroup, e.g.  $C(\langle 3, 5 \rangle) = F(\langle 3, 5 \rangle) + 1 = 8$

Note that  $\langle a_0, a_1, \dots, a_n \rangle$  can be expressed as  $\langle x^{a_0}, x^{a_1}, \dots, x^{a_n} \rangle$ , as the algebraic structure is identical with polynomial multiplication. This notation is helpful when discussing Schur rings.

## Definition

The coarsest Schur ring is the partition such that if  $a, b \in S$  always have the same coefficient in  $\mathbb{Z}[S]$ , then  $a, b$  are combined into the same element of the partition.

## Schur Rings Cont.

Let  $S = \langle x^3, x^5 \rangle$ .

Start by combining the generators,  $x^3 + x^5$ .

Then check higher orders.

$$(x^3 + x^5)^2 = x^6 + 2x^8 + x^{10}$$

There is no other way to generate  $x^6$  or  $x^{10}$ , so they can be combined.

Similarly, there is no other way to generate  $x^8$ , so it is a singleton.



## Schur Rings Cont.

$$(x^3 + x^5)^3 = x^9 + 3x^{11} + 3x^{13} + x^{15}$$

$x^{15} \in S^5, x^9 \notin S^5$ , thus they are both singletons.

$x^{11}, x^{13}$ ? They both can only be generated by  $x^8(x^3 + x^5)$ , so they can be combined.

No further combining is possible.

Final Coarsest Schur Ring:  $x^3 + x^5, x^6 + x^{10}, x^8, x^9, x^{11} + x^{13}, x^{12}, \rightarrow$

Finer Schur rings are possible.

# Primary Research Question

## Conjecture

All Schur Rings over numerical semigroups are eventually discrete.

# Theorems

## Theorem 1

For  $S = \langle p, q \rangle$  where  $p < q$  and  $\gcd(p, q) = 1$ , no element of  $S$  greater than  $(p + q)(p - 1)$  can be combined in a Schur ring.

## Theorem 2

For any numerical semigroup of the form  $S = \langle m, m + 1, m + 2, \dots, 2m - 1 \rangle$ , any Schur ring over  $S$  is eventually discrete.

## Theorem 3

For the numerical semigroup,  $S = \langle a_0, a_1, \dots, a_k \rangle$ , if  $\gcd(a_i, a_j) = 1$  for all  $0 \leq i, j \leq k$  with  $i \neq j$ , then any Schur ring over  $S$  is eventually discrete.

# Sketch of Proof of Theorem 1

## Theorem 1

For  $S = \langle p, q \rangle$  where  $p < q$  and  $\gcd(p, q) = 1$ , no element of  $S$  greater than  $(p + q)(p - 1)$  can be combined in a Schur ring.

## Proof

For  $s \in S$ , there exists a unique maximal decomposition which contains more generators than all other decompositions.

Two elements of  $S$  can only have a maximal decomposition of the same order if they are both less than  $(p + q)(p - 1)$

A similar theorem for 3 generators was recently developed.

# Sketch of Proof of Theorem 2

## Theorem 2

For any numerical semigroup of the form  $S = \langle m, m+1, m+2, \dots, 2m-1 \rangle$ , any Schur ring over  $S$  is eventually discrete.

## Proof

$$\begin{aligned}(x^m + x^{m+1} + \dots + x^{2m-1})^2 &= x^{2m} + 2x^{2m+1} + \dots + bx^{3m-2} + ax^{3m-1} + bx^{3m} + \dots + x^{4m-2} \\ (x^m + x^{m+1} + \dots + x^{2m-1})^3 &= x^{3m} + \dots\end{aligned}$$

Thus  $3m-1$  and  $3m$  are both singletons. Note also  $\gcd(3m-1, 3m) = 1$ . This generates a numerical semigroup within the Schur ring, which is eventually discrete.

# Sketch of Proof of Theorem 3

## Theorem 3

For a numerical semigroup,  $S = \langle a_0, a_1, \dots, a_k \rangle$ , if  $\gcd(a_i, a_j) = 1$  for all  $0 \leq i, j \leq k$  with  $i \neq j$ , then any Schur ring over  $S$  is eventually discrete.

## Proof

The case for 2 and 3 generators are covered by other theorems. For 4 or more, two coprime singletons can be guaranteed within the Schur ring.

# New Paradigm

## Definition

"Freshman Exponentiation" for a polynomial  $X = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n$ , denoted  $X^{(m)}$  is defined as  $X^{(m)} = a_0^m + (a_1x)^m + \dots + (a_nx^n)^m$ .

## Definition

The Hadamard product of two polynomials

$X_a = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n$ ,  $X_b = b_0 + b_1x + \dots + b_mx^m$ , denoted  $X_a \circ X_b$  is defined as  $X_a \circ X_b = \sum_{i=0}^k a_i b_i x^i$  where  $k = \max(n, m)$ .

A Schur ring is closed under both operations.

## Two Generator Case

Let  $S = \langle a, b \rangle$ . Thus  $x^a + x^b$  is an element of the Schur Ring over  $S$ .

Consider  $(x^a + x^b)^2 = x^{2a} + 2x^{a+b} + x^{2b}$ . No two terms of this polynomial can be combined, as  $a \neq b$ , thus  $x^{a+b}$  is a singleton in the partition for the Schur Ring.

Consider  $(x^a + x^b)^{(a)} \circ (x^a + x^b)^{(b)}$ .

$$\begin{aligned} & (x^a + x^b)^{(a)} \circ (x^a + x^b)^{(b)} \\ &= (x^{a^2} + x^{ab}) \circ (x^{ab} + x^{b^2}) \\ &= x^{ab} \text{ because } a \neq b \end{aligned}$$

Thus  $x^{ab}$  is a singleton in the Schur Ring.



## Two Generator Case Cont.

Note  $\gcd(a + b, ab) = 1$ , as  $\gcd(a, b) = 1$ .

Therefore  $x^{a+b}, x^{ab}$  form a numerical semigroup in the Schur Ring, meaning the Schur Ring is eventually discrete.

Note the argument can be extended to 3 and 4 generators.

A modified form of this argument can be inducted to any number of generators.

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Numerical Semigroups and Applications

# The End